

Communications Kit

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · October 2026

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Status: DRAFT for local review, 2026-10-05. Not legal advice. Hackles has not been reviewed, approved or endorsed by FLDOE or any state agency. It has not been evaluated in a controlled study. Every legal or statistical statement is marked [VERIFY] or [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]; ask your own counsel before relying on it.

Ready-to-paste text for newsletters, your website, social channels and family nights. Keep every message true to what the kit is: a free, unplugged, pilot-stage resource. Have your communications office and counsel approve it first.
[COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

Claims rules for every message

SAY	DO NOT SAY
"free," "no student accounts," "the lessons collect no student data"	"keeps kids safe," "protects children," "prevents sextortion"
"built on published principles of prevention education: practice, several sessions, no shame" [VERIFY]	"proven," "evidence-based program," "research-validated," "clinically tested"
"has not been evaluated in a controlled study"	"increases reporting" or "reduces fear"
"mapped to" standards	"aligned with," "certified by," "meets [state] mandate," "CIPA compliant"
"a free kit from Competence Collective"	"approved by," "endorsed by," "in partnership with" any agency or group
"we chose it as a supplemental resource"	"state-approved," "required by the state" (unless your counsel confirms a requirement)

NO STUDENT PHOTOS, NAMES, quotes or work in any promotion unless your own consent process allows it. The kit's default is no.

Newsletter blurbs

Short (40 words), for a school or district e-newsletter

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
This [month], [grade or class] begins Hackles, a free set of 15-minute lessons on staying safe and kind online. Students practice a simple habit: Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. Families will get a note before each lesson that covers a more sensitive topic. Questions: [contact].	

Medium (90 words)

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
Our school has chosen Hackles, a free online-safety kit from Competence Collective, as a supplemental resource for [grades]. Each week, students practice noticing the "something is off" feeling, pausing, checking, and telling a trusted adult. Lessons use paper and projected slides. The kit has no student accounts and collects no student data. A few lessons cover sensitive topics such as unsafe contact and fake images, and we will write to families two weeks ahead, with a chance to preview materials or choose an alternate activity. Contact [name] at [email].	

Long (parent explainer), for a back-to-school packet

FIELD NOTE	No. 3
What is Hackles? Hackles are what rise on the back of your neck when something feels off. The lessons help children notice that feeling and act on it. A false alarm is welcome. If a child is ever tricked, it is not their fault, and the next step is always the same: tell someone. What will my child do? Short, practical activities: spot a fake message, build a strong passphrase, practice saying "I need help" to a trusted adult, and talk through what to do when someone online pushes for secrets or pictures. What will it not do? It does not teach children to attack computers. It does not require accounts or collect personal information. It is not a substitute for your family's values or for our school's safeguarding work. About the kit. Hackles is free and comes from Competence Collective, a company that also makes training for colleges and professionals. It has not been evaluated in a controlled study, and it is not approved by any state agency. We chose it because [your reason]. How can I help? Ask your child to show you the take-home card after each lesson. Choose a family code word. Tell your child they will never be punished for telling you about something online.	

Website blurb

Headline: Hackles online-safety lessons at [School or District]

FIELD NOTE	No. 4
[School or District] uses Hackles, a free online-safety kit, as a supplemental resource for [grades]. The lessons teach students to notice when something online feels wrong, pause, check, and tell a trusted adult. Students do not make accounts, and the lessons do not collect student data. Families: You can preview the lessons, ask for an alternate activity for sensitive lessons, and find conversation starters and a family tech agreement. [Link to materials page.] Contact [name, email, phone]. Notes: Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled study and is not approved or endorsed by [state education agency] or any other agency. [If posting kit files, link to the accessibility statement and offer alternate formats on request.] [local fill: any instructional-materials notice your state requires. VERIFY]	

Social posts

KEEP POSTS SHORT, FACTUAL, and free of student images. Add the school's own hashtag and no outside tags. [Check your social-media policy.]

1. Starting [date], our [grade] classes begin Hackles, a free online-safety kit. Weekly 15-minute lessons. Habit of the month: Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. [link]
2. Families: a note goes home before any Hackles lesson that covers a sensitive topic. You can preview materials and choose an alternate activity. Questions: [contact].
3. Tip for home: pick a family code word. If someone calls or messages, claiming to be family and asking for help or money, ask for the code word. The kit has a guide. [link]
4. Tell your child this tonight: "If something online ever feels off, you can tell me. You will not be in trouble." That is the whole lesson.
5. Hackles Day is [date]. Stations, a puzzle hunt and a family corner. All free. Families welcome from [time]. [link]
6. Reminder: our counselor [name] is available during Hackles lessons. Students can always ask to talk. [contact]

Safer Internet Day (February) and National Cybersecurity Awareness Month (October). Pair a post with a classroom activity. [VERIFY the current year's dates before you schedule.]

Parent-night agenda cross-reference

THE KIT ALREADY CONTAINS a full parent-night resource. Use those, not a new one.

NEED	WHERE IN THE KIT
75-minute family night agenda and a presenter script	kit/07_Assessment/Hackles_Day_Kit.md, section 8 (parent and family night agenda), and the format "Parent and family night (evening, 75 minutes)" in section 3
Parent-night presentation script	kit/12_Facilitator_Kit/Parent_Night_Presentation_Script.md
Handouts for families	kit/06_Family/Family_Engagement_Pack.md: conversation starters, Family Tech Agreement, Family Code Word guide, "What to do if your child tells you something scary"
Slide support	kit/25_Slides for lesson slides; the Workshop Slide Deck Outline in kit/12_Facilitator_Kit
Family feedback form	Hackles Day Kit, section 13 (family form). Collect on paper without names

A suggested 60-minute family night outline (edit with the script above)

MINUTES	ITEM
0 to 5	Welcome and what Hackles is. Say plainly that it is free, has not been approved by a state agency, and has not yet been evaluated
5 to 15	Try an activity together: Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. with one low-stakes scenario
15 to 30	Family code word and the "you will not be punished for telling" promise. Practice the first sentence a child can say
30 to 40	What if my child tells me something scary? (one-pager)
40 to 50	Questions. Preview table for sensitive lessons
50 to 60	Counselor on hand. Take-home card and resource sheet

Have a counselor present. Do not invite students to share their own experiences.

Press and social-media inquiries

IF A REPORTER OR commenter asks something your claims rules do not cover, say: "Hackles is a free kit we chose as a supplemental resource. Please ask [contact] for details." Do not offer statistics you have not verified. Do not name any student.

Things to avoid

- Naming the vendor as a "partner." You use a free resource; no partnership exists.
- Putting the publisher's logo on school materials in a way that suggests the publisher endorses your program.
- Linking to Competence Collective's other products from student-facing pages. Adult-facing pages may mention it once, honestly.
- Alarming statistics. The kit's own guidance is to describe skills, not frighten families.